



Atul Vivek
Chief Business Officer,
Alcatel India

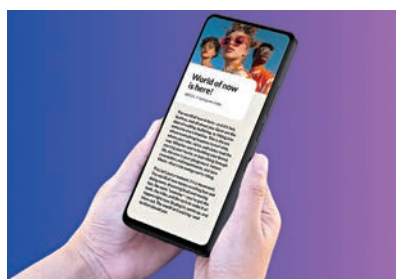
Alcatel's India comeback

Atul Vivek, Chief Business Officer at Alcatel India, explains why the brand has returned

Mustafa Khan | editor@digit.in

Alcatel is like MG Motors in India. It is a legacy brand worldwide that has made a comeback in India. Many might not know about the brand in the country, but this French consumer electronics brand is trying to find its niche in the huge Indian tech market. The comeback is being headlined by a very interesting product – the Alcatel V3 Ultra, a sub-₹ 20,000 smartphone. As per the brand, the device blends ergonomic design, local manufacturing, and a unique “nxtpaper” display aimed at eye comfort. But what exactly is Alcatel betting on?

To find that out, Digit had an exclusive chat with Atul Vivek, Chief Business Officer at Alcatel India. He shared details about why the brand decided to make a comeback in India after so many years, and what their strategy is.



V3 Ultra: What's in a name?

Before heading into any of the details, we were curious to know what went behind the naming of the “Alcatel V3 Ultra”. “Naming conventions in the smartphone world are crowded; most alphabets have already been taken,” laughs the executive.

Alcatel leaned into its legacy to name the V3 Ultra. The “V” comes from a phonetic familiarity and the feeling of community, while the “3” is a subtle

callback to Alcatel's earlier “OneTouch” series. The word “Ultra” is not about flagship specs, but rather refers to the stylus and the phone's standout display tech, as per Vivek.

Nxtpaper display: Niche or gamechanger?

The V3 Ultra's calling card is its unique nxtpaper display. While it might appear as a “reading-first” display, the team was quick to clarify that the tech is designed for multimedia and extended usage. “Reading is secondary, maybe tertiary,” says the CBO. “The main focus is to deliver vibrant content while reducing eye strain.”

Unlike OLEDs that rely on software-based grayscale, the nextpaper display features five hardware layers to achieve contrast along with colour control. “It's not a coating or software trick. It's built into the screen,” he explains. With a contrast ratio of 1500:1, the panel promises deep blacks and rich visuals, while an anti-reflective layer makes it ideal for outdoor use. “Because it doesn't reflect much light, what you see is what you get, even in sunlight,” he says.

Sub- ₹20,000: The new mass segment

Alcatel is placing its bets on the ₹10,000 to ₹20,000 segment, which accounts for nearly 87% of India's smartphone market. This bracket is now considered the new “mass” category as consumers move beyond entry-level phones into their second or third device. Easy digital credit options have significantly accelerated this shift, allowing users to own better and faster smartphones.

“Less than 10K used to be the mass segment, but that has shifted,” says the executive. “Now people are buying their second or third device, and they want something better. A 15K or 20K phone is the natural upgrade.” **[d]**

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